

Problem 5. Mongo Answers and Explanation (1/2)

Total: 52 points

Problem 5. Mongo

5.1	a <i>He didn't teach you (sg).</i>	5.2	a lóójengengaka
	b <i>You (sg) treated us today.</i>		b ntálogángélá
	c <i>We insulted him. / We insulted you (pl).</i>		c óololímisaka
	d <i>I didn't fly.</i>		d batátófínga

Q 5.1 Max 10. 2pts each, 1pt with one mistake. Ignore incorrect second sentence; award 2pts for fully correct second sentence.

Q 5.2 Max 16. Follow the following algorithm:

- Segment the word as best as possible into slots -3 to 1 as in the solution. Allow for slots to be empty, morphemes to be invented or misspelled, etc.
- Call this segmented word with tone markings ignored the *bare form*.
- Determine the *written polarity* as following, allowing for misspellings:
 - If **-ta-** is written and not **-ka**, call it *negative*. Vice versa, call it *affirmative*.
 - If both are written, or both slots -2 and 1 are empty, etc., call it *mixed*.
 - If *affirmative* or *negative* can otherwise be confidently assigned, do; else call it *mixed*.
- 1pt if slots -3 to -1 are correct in the bare form.
- 1pt if slots 0 and 1 are correct in the bare form.
- 1pt if the tone rules have been correctly applied in slots -2 and 1, given the written polarity.
 - Note that this is independent of the bare form being correct.
 - If it would be impossible to consistently apply tone rules to the bare form (e.g. morphemes are missing, written polarity is mixed), do not award the point.
- 1pt if the tone rules have been correctly applied in slots -3, -1 and 0, given the written polarity.
 - Note that this is independent of the bare form being correct.
 - If it would be impossible to consistently apply tone rules to the bare form (e.g. there is no subject, the stem is invented and not an obvious misspelling of a given stem, written polarity is mixed), do not award the point.
 - Allow for missing objects where they should be present.
 - Note that the tone rules for the stem are that the first tone is lexically determined, the second (if present) copies the following tone.

Q 5.3 Max 26. 12pts for morphology; 14pts for tone rules.

Problem 5. Mongo Explanation (2/2)

Explanation

A Mongo verb complex has the following general structure:

-3 SUBJECT	-2 POLARITY	-1 OBJECT	0 ROOT	1 POLARITY
1sg = n- 2sg = o- 3sg = a- 1pl = to- 2pl = lo- 3pl = ba-	Negative: -tá- Affirmative: -o- before C -ol- before V	2sg = -ko- 3sg = -o- 1pl = -to- 2pl = -lo- 3pl = -a-	<i>insult</i> = fíng <i>forgive</i> = límis <i>fly</i> = jengeng <i>teach</i> = lak <i>oust</i> = bengan <i>scold</i> = gángel <i>treat</i> = tút	Affirmative: -aka Negative: -a You could analyse the root as containing an -a as well.

Note: alternative analyses with **-l-** are possible.

Tone is as in the table above, with low tones raising in the following situations:

- The subject has high tone in affirmative verb forms.
- **-o(l)-** has high tone if the action did not happen today.
- **-a** has high tone if the action did not happen today.
- The second vowel of a two-syllable root takes the tone of the following vowel.